

1 Definitions

- **(W1) Mental grammar:** Our unconscious knowledge of language
- **Linguistic creativity:** Dictionaries don't carry all, trees can be ∞ large
- **Conscious/unconscious:** Conscious is introspectable.
- **Dialect:** Same language family. Mutually intelligible. Has systemic grammatical differences.
 - **AAVE:** null/unconjugated copula, "I been seen it", can't nobody beat 'em
- **Standard English:** Ver. of English perceived to be "correct" by prescriptivists (in NA, this is "General American")
- **(W2) Morpheme:** Smallest unit.
 - Free: can exist on its own.
 - Bound: $\cup$
- **Stem:** (Root + Af) $\cup$ (Stem + Af)
- **Base:** (Root $\cup$ Stem) $\cap$ affix attachable
- **Inflection:** +gram, X(ch.mean)
- **Derivation:** Af. chg. (class)/(meaning significantly). *Always applied before inflection*
- **Conversion:** Floor it! (N $\rightarrow$ V)
- **Compounding:** Build new word from 2 free morphemes
- **Internal change:** Chg. non morphemic seg. e.g. sing $\rightarrow$ sang
- **Suppletion:** complete change for grammatical contrast (be $\rightarrow$ is)
- **Backformation:** Result of "Morphemes" removed by accident
- **Productivity:** af. that can be added to *nearly all* words of intended word class
- **Principle of compositionality:** Word meaning built up from morphemes
- **(W3) Endocentric:** Headful (exo: less). Note: In *chicken soup*, chicken is a noun adjunct
- **Exocentric:** Headless $V[[N \text{ tip}], [N \text{ toe}]]$
- **Coordinative:** and-join.

Coord+endo rare e.g.

writer-director, bittersweet

multiple heads allowed

- **Subordinative:** meaning via head; hierarchical, sub $\Rightarrow$ endo.
- **Constituent:** building block (tree part)
- **Syntactic category:** Group of expr. that can express one another w/o losing grammaticality (e.g. see below $\downarrow$)
- **Phrasal cat.:** NP/VP/AP/PP/AdvP
- **Lexical cat.:** N/V/A/P/Adv
- **Functional cat.:**
Det(a,the,), T(could), Conj(or), Compl(that,if). Closed class, small, builds grammatical structure.
- **Noun:** Combines with DET to form NP
 - Count: +(many/a/3); Mass: +(much/ $\emptyset$)
- **Verb:** actions.
 - **Verb string:** A sequence of verbs in a sentence. Ex: *might have been eating* is one verb string. In a sentence, they may be split (Have you been eating) $\rightarrow$ *Have been eating* is the verb string. Verb strings are separate **if**: one part is an infinitive, they're joined by conjunctions (and), or *I **knew** he had lied*.
 - Verb and its inflectional material make up the sentence. Verb determines what other part can occur in the sentence.
- **Transitivity depends on the use of the verb.**
 - **Intransitive:** no direct object
 - **Transitive:** single direct object
 - **Ditransitive:** appears with 2 objects
 - * *A gave [the gift] [to B]*, loses gram if either [] removed.
- **Adjectives:** expressing qualities or state
 - **[Pos] Attributive-na:** In the NP. **Predicative** otherwise
 - **[Deg] Gradable:** normally in predicative position. Modifiable w/ words like "very"/"quite"

- **Scale:** Measurable w/ unit. Gradable $\Rightarrow$ Scale (converse not true: "freezing"). Compat. w/ unit of measurement $\Rightarrow$ (scale & gradable)
- Modifiable w/ intensifiers (only case where not immediate AP)
- **Adverbs:** express info. abt time, manner, place, freq. They head phrases.
 - Modifiable w/ intensifiers (which are adverbs) (very); remains an AdvP. Connective advs (however, then) cannot take modifiers (*very however)
- **Prepositions:** Express relationships, e.g. spatial, directional, reason, cause, means.
 - at, on, from, of, off, in, to, into, about, b4.
 - Test: " the house?"
 - Combine with NPs to make PPs
 - Some prepositions can be modified w/ adverbs (right *around*, deep/far *into*, very much *behind*) – still a PP
- **Determiners:** Restrict ref. of noun it combines w/ (the, a/an, my/your/his, this/that, whose, some/all/many)
 - Do not permit any inflectional or derivational affixes once added! NP $\rightarrow$ D+NP
- **Conjunctions:** link phrases. Usually link units of same category or diff. ones **if** alike in function (great person_{NP} & fun to be around(AP))
- **Complementizers:** Link clause to some other element (after/as/if/until/*that*) – "she slept after she drank".
- **Phrases:** sequences of words w/ some sort of grammar relationship w/ another, phrase = constituent
 - Inherit properties of most important element (head): warm **water**, **drive** quickly. Phrases are nestable. Test for phrases like constituents.

$XP \left[\text{Spec}, \left[X' \left[\left[X', \text{Compl} \right] \right] \right] \right]$
 Modifier

- **Modifier:** elements not closely linked to the head, but still part of the same phrase as the head & complement.
- **Auxiliaries:** Helper verbs adding grammatical meaning to sentence and must accompany other verb
- **Predicate:** What's left over in a sentence when subject removed
- **Subject:** The doer of the action
 - Subject-aux inversion: can switch places in a yes-no question. No aux → dummy “do”. **Some adverbials** can force inversion (never had he)
 - Finite verb must agree with the properties of NP subjects
 - Phrasal categories (such as NPs, PPs, some VPs) can function as subjects
 - Sentence initial except some adverbials (such as yesterday)
- **Modals:** may, might, will, must, can. Cannot be non-infinitive, usually not marked for tense; different ordering for negations; Modal ⇒ auxiliary (but not converse)
- **Subject/Object case:** He vs him. Nouns have lost its case system, though
- **Phrasal verb:** Give up, lock in; up/in not movable

2 Procedures

2.1 Compound Vs. -Phrase

- Compounds stress 1st syllable (DOLLhouse)
- Compounds can't coordinate (*[doll & tree] house). Try add one & fail ⇒ compound

2.2 W4 - Constituency Tests

Changing tenses of a verb in the string to be test is fine. E.g. “photographed the ocean” can be written as “photograph the ocean” when doing this test.

SUBSTITUTION – Replace w/ pro-form (e.g. he/him, did so, there, one. You are allowed to change the determiner, e.g. the ↔ this instead of the noun (or both)). Det omissible

SENTENCE FRAGMENT – str is answer to **any** wh-question, which must contain all material from original sentence

MOVEMENT-FRONTING – L plays outside → outside, L plays.

↑-**IT(BASIC)-CLEFT** – It is s that o
 ↑-**WH(PSEUDO)-CLEFT** – [wh-word] oth is/(did was) str

REDUCTION – ... big birds → birds

OMISSION – can be removed

2.3 W5 – Complement or Modifier

Complement – element w/ close relationship to head. Modifier – optional. Test performed w/ the phrase. **Test FAILS ⇒ complement.**

- **[M-VP]** Did-so sub (*I did so the pasta)
- **[M-NP]** Pro-NP sub (*the **one** of physics steals)
- **[M-VP/NP;FNR]** Omission
- **[M-VP/NP]** Reordering (john ran in the park with them → john ran with them in the park)

2.4 Phrasal Structure

Indirect objects are the complement of an existing very constituent.

$TP [NP, T' [T [+PST], VP]]$

2.5 Telling Objects Apart

How do I tell if something is an object rather than a subject:

- Can be put into passive form (passive voice)
- Case (he/him)
- Objects follow the verb. Indirect objects go left of direct objects. Indirect objects are recipients or beneficiaries which may also be expressed as PPs with heads like “to” or “for”. When expressed in this way phrases are called adverbial complements

2.5.1 Adverbial Complements vs. Indirect Object

- Adverbials answer wh-questions. E.g. *quickly, in the park*. An adverbial **complement** is an adverbial that can't be removed.
- You can front adverbial complements, but they can't be made passive (to that fish you should never have fed steroids)
- You can passivize indirect objects but not adverbial complements (that fish should never have been fed, *that fish you should never have fed steroids)

2.6 Predicative Complement

Predicate complements describe either subject or object in a clause.

- Subject complements refer to/modify the subject: The A is B
- Object complements: A considered C B

Predicative vs. Object

1. Coreference/Description:

Predicative ⇔ EQUALITY relation

- a. Subjects and objects have distinct references unless reflexive pronoun as object

2. Coreference: Predicative can describe the location of the subject or the object and cannot be removed.

- a. A put B around the cake.

3. Passivation: only objects can be passivized

4. Number agreement: She is a B. *They are a B

5. Phrasal categories: Predicative complements can be NP, AP, or PP.

6. Position: Subject complements often follow the verb. Object complements follow the object

2.7 VP Tree Tips

$V' \left[\begin{array}{c} V [\text{makes}] \\ AP [NP [\text{Dave}], A' [\text{Young}]] \end{array} \right]$
 $VP [V' [V' \text{ did so}], [AdvP \text{ quickly}]]$
 $V' [V \text{ handed}] [NP \text{ them}(C)] [NP \text{ it}(C)]$